

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 237

By Jones J

A RESOLUTION to recognize and commend Vivian Lee Battle Sims.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should specially recognize those estimable public servants who, through their extraordinary efforts, have become leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Vivian Lee Battle Sims, a ninety-six-year-old retired Giles County educator who has sought numerous opportunities to both selflessly serve citizens in her community and recognize the storied history of this State; and

WHEREAS, Vivian Sims was the first African-American female assistant principal of Pulaski Elementary School, and she later became the first African-American principal of Southside Elementary School; and

WHEREAS, for nearly five decades, Ms. Sims has selflessly served her hometown through community involvement and direction, earning the utmost respect and admiration of her peers and community alike; and

WHEREAS, a highly respected member of the Giles County community for more than sixty years, Vivian Sims rallied the town leaders and championed the placement of *The Resurrection of Valor* statue in 2023; and

WHEREAS, the bronze statue currently stands in Pulaski, honoring and recognizing the United States Colored Troops (USCT) who proudly fought for freedom in the American Civil War; and

WHEREAS, *The Resurrection of Valor* exhibits a young child looking up to a USCT soldier and serves as a powerful, historic hallmark of legacy, courage, and pride for the descendants of the brave warriors who fought for our freedoms; and

WHEREAS, the journey was personal to Ms. Sims, who herself is a direct descendant of a USCT soldier; she initially brought the idea to a Community Advisory Committee meeting for Inclusive Recognition and Acknowledgement and ultimately invested her time and resources to the project, which included \$82,000 of her own money; and

WHEREAS, as a professional, Ms. Sims devoted her entire forty-six-year career to the education field; and

WHEREAS, Vivian Sims is an exemplary citizen whose commitment to helping others through volunteerism and faith is representative of the Volunteer State, and it is highly appropriate that she should be recognized; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Vivian Lee Battle Sims for her leadership, thank her for her sterling service to the citizens of the State of Tennessee, and extend to her our best wishes for every continued success in her future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.